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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Euhareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021

\$2.50 Inc GST

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival

Friday 10 April
Sunday 12 April

No. 216

THURSDAY, JANUARY 22, 2026 ISSN 2653-2026

Lions and Soldiers Club join forces again for Uni scholarships
- P3

Vic and Karol Howe celebrate 60th wedding anniversary
- P4

Touch Footy rep sides success at Griffith championships and Swim Country Regionals PHOTOS
- P14 - 15



Nacap Pty Ltd's Peter Stewart with the 19 Wellingtonians before they headed to Canberra on Monday for a week of education mixed with a lot of fun.

WINS – NACAP join forces in community bus tour

FIFTEEN YOUNG Wellingtonians are on a journey of a lifetime spending a week in Canberra.

The “Wello to Capital Tour 2026 has been organised by WINS (Wellington Information & Neighbourhood Services) through the sponsorship of Nacap Pty Ltd.

The tour group accompanied by four supervisors will be kept entertained with a mixture of fun activities and learning experience.

Visits include Mini Golf, the Aquatic Centre, Questacon (Science and Technology Museum) and the National Zoo and Aquarium.

The flexibility in the schedule allows for ad hoc visits to other points of interest should the need arise.

At the accommodation, the group will have access to plenty of amenities to keep entertained like a pool and spa, tennis courts, a landscaped activities area, basketball and volleyball courts and a table tennis area.

Nacap Pty Ltd, who are the Principal Construction Contractor for the Ungula Windfarm, is supporting the Canberra for local youth living in and around the Wellington area.

The young Wellingtonians are from a broad spectrum of the community and will enjoy an array of experiences that they normally wouldn't have available in the local district.

The sponsorship includes all transport services by way of a luxury coach provided by Langley's of Dubbo and high visibility tour shirts to assist organisers in identifying the children in potentially crowded situations.

As part of the Nacap's commitment to leave a lasting legacy within the Wellington community, Nacap's Lands, Environment & Cultural Heritage manager, Peter Stewart, said Nacap was proud to sponsor the WINS (Wellington Information & Neighbourhood Services) Community Centre “Wello to Capital Tour 2026.

“Nacap is committed to creating a positive and lasting legacy in the regional centres in which it works,” Mr Stewart said.

“By helping to educate and open the eyes of Wellington's youth, it is hoped that this trip may inspire some in their growth as an individual but also encourage participants to seek further education opportunities as they mature into adulthood.”

Wellington's Australia Day in Cameron Park this Sunday

Come'on down to Cameron Park from 5pm this Sunday for the 2026 Wellington Australia Day celebrations.

There will be facepainting and the Bubble Fairy, free barbecue followed by the annual Australia Day Community Awards presentation.

‘Beyond Best Before’ visionary siblings are our Australia Day Ambassadors and have a wonderful story for all about their social impact enterprise.

Australia Day Community Awards presentation commence at 6pm and include Citizen of the Year; Senior Citizen of the Year, Young Citizen of the Year, Sportsperson and Young Sportsperson; Community Event and several Community Service/Achievement Awards.

Inside this week

Wellington Show Young Woman Clair Stiff heads to Zone Final - P 5

Footpath improvements in Wellington

COUNCIL IS continuing works on footpath improvements in Wellington, with Glasson Street (between Simpson and Thornton streets) having existing kerb and guttering removed this week.

This will prepare the site for new kerb and guttering to be laid throughout February, finishing in March, weather permitting.

These works complement upgrades occurring in Parkes Street.

Cemetery Clean Up

Council teams are out this week cleaning and maintaining regional cemeteries in readiness for any visitors over the public holiday.

You can assist the team caring for these spaces by following guidelines on permitted placement of flowers and tributes and returning to collect any items again.

We encourage visiting friends and families to tidy plots of loved ones while there, especially after storm events when tributes can be damaged.

If you notice anything needing attention you can submit a request or report through

our DRC&ME Portal, or call 68014000.

Find out more about visiting our cemeteries <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/cemeteries>

SURVEY: Rural Waste Services

Council wants to hear about your experience with Rural Waste Management.

We're seeking your input to better understand how waste services are used, where improvements can be made, and how well our services align with community expectations.

It will also guide future fees and charges and support efforts to reduce landfill and build a circular economy.

Take a few minutes to have your say. Community Consultation is currently open and closes at 9am Wednesday, 28 January 2026. Go to:

<https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/>

Australia Day Ambassadors

Ambassadors Katie, Maggie and Michael Quach will deliver inspiring messages to the Wellington community during our

Australia Day event this year.

Kate, Maggie and Michael Quach are the visionary siblings behind Beyond Best Before, a social-impact enterprise tackling food waste and promoting sustainable living.

In 2025, their work earned international recognition with a place on the Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia list for Social Impact, highlighting their leadership in sustainability and innovation.

New Website Home to Digital Collection!

Council has launched the new Reveal Collections website, home to digital records of the heritage and art collections from across our region.

The website has a catalogue of objects, documents and artworks from the Western Plains Cultural Centre, Old Dubbo Gaol and Wellington Caves.

The project also supported the digitisation of the Dundullimal Homestead - National Trust of Australia NSW collection.

Currently there are 126 items available in

the digitised collection on the website.

The website is an ongoing project with new objects to be added in the future.

This project was funded by NSW Government's Create NSW Creative Capital Grant Fund. Check it out at: <https://collections.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/explore>

Report Issues to Council

Please contact Council to report issues that need attention.

That's a better approach than letting the issue fester away or having a spray on face-book.

Call: 6801 4000 or report via DRC&ME; the Snap SendSolve app on your phone; email council@dubbo.nsw.gov.au; or via the Front Desk at the Council Building.

Report Street Lights for fixing to Essential Energy

Report crime to CrimeStoppers – This may result in an increase in crime statistics, but ultimately helps to get a greater allocation of resources for Wellington and surrounds (ie more police).

Josh Black

Eraring Power Station to continue powering state

ORIGIN ENERGY has notified the NSW Government, the Australian Stock Exchange and the Australian Energy Market Operator that it will operate Eraring Power Station until April 2029.

According to state energy minister Penny Sharpe, Origin's decision gives certainty to workers, the market and energy consumers across the state, as well as contributing to NSW's 2030 emissions reduction target.

"My number one job is keeping the lights on and putting downward pressure on power prices," Ms Sharpe said.

"NSW is making real progress replacing ageing coal-fired power stations. "Since the election, we have increased the amount of renewable energy capacity in operation by almost 70 per cent.

"That's equivalent to Eraring's capacity."

Ms Sharpe said current energy security projections showed NSW expected to have sufficient energy supply when Eraring closed in 2029, thanks to new renewable generation and storage coming online.

"The agreement reached with Origin in 2024 gets the balance right and has so far not cost NSW taxpayers a single dollar," she said.

The NSW Government secured an agreement with Origin Energy in 2024 to underwrite the Eraring Power Station until August 2027, to ensure energy reliability and avoid price spikes for households and businesses.

The agreement also requires Eraring's closure by no later than April 2029, to support emissions reduction and provide certainty for investment in replacement generation.

The agreement remains in place without amendment.

The NSW Government's offer of two years of underwriting will end in 2027 and is not being extended.

To date, Origin has not opted into the underwriting arrangement and taxpayers have not paid a single dollar to keep Eraring operating.

Origin has until March 2026 to notify the NSW Government if it will opt-in to the risk-sharing arrangement for the 2026-2027 financial year.

Letter to the Editor

WE CAN only hope that recent political developments, involving the Renewable Energy Debate result in the separation of "Emissions Reduction" from "Climate Change" to enable meaningful debate.

Emissions Reduction is a quantifiable thing whereas Climate Change is opinionated and speculative (other than our planet's history telling us of the non-human extreme climate changes over millions of years).

Until now individuals who raise any reasonable concerns in respect to renewables development specifics are invariably attacked as "Climate Deniers" and any chance of factual debate is shut down.

It's not completely unlike, when as kids our mother demanded we do something and we asked why, and she replied "Because I Said So" Debate ended!

As a background, on leaving school in 1963, I worked for an engineering company with a Pollution and Dust Control Division, and this gave me an initial insight into, particularly industrial emissions and their environmental and human consequences and this has stayed with me.

With this background and living in a Renewable Energy Zone, having our view of the landscape covered in solar panels, and being asked for permission to run ugly transmission lines, personally involves me, and knowing political influence and not current technology availability,

to make much of this eyesore unnecessary, annoys me.

Prior to the present Federal Government we had the highest application of Roof Top Solar in the world and 40 per cent lower electricity cost and with a current Electricity Availability Charge of \$1.96 day and a usage cost of 43.38cents per KWh who knows where this will end up when the monstrosity is completed (and most likely obsolete).

Fortunately, those with well-designed Roof Top Solar/Battery installations, can minimise their end of quarter bill at present.

As an example, we installed a system designed by Will Redfern from Redfern Country Solar, when we moved to town, and with a feed in tariff of just - cents/KWh we are offsetting our bill by around \$120/day and our FIRST end of quarter bill is projected to be around \$70 according to our Origin Energy apps.

Such is life.

Roger Everett

Last Satellite for Yeoval community

SO LONG, FAREWELL...FOR NOW IT WAS with mixed feelings that the small volunteer team has put the final issue of the Satellite community newspaper to bed for 2025.

With no new volunteers stepping forward, the Satellite may cease publication in 2026 after 68 remarkable years.

While this is deeply disappointing, it also reflects the changing times.

For those former elderly volunteers who hold strong connections to the Satellite—Beryl, Joyce, Heather, Sylvia, Evelyn, Marilyn, Valerie, Sharon and the many, many others whose involvement stretches back to its beginnings in 1957—I want to express a heartfelt thank you.

You paved the way for change and graciously stepped aside when you had



given all you could, allowing the younger generations to step in (sometimes with trepidation, I'm sure!).

Because of our community's dedication, the Satellite proudly celebrated its 68th birthday in November—a tremendous achievement for a small village thriving in the new millennium.

Signing off edition 4025...

Nikki T-H, Vicky and Jane

YEOVAL SATELLITE VOLUNTEERS

Editor: Nikki Tremain-Hennock—0417 429 144 / 6846 4400

E: yeovalsatellite@outlook.com

Invoicing: Jane Coady—0427 225 296 |

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Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999

email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager
Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998

email: sharon@wdleader.news

Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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In lodging an advertisement with us you agree that we may publish the advertisement on our website. The general terms and conditions that apply to publication of advertisements in our publication apply also to publication of material on our website. Advertising conditions of the Wellington & District Leader are available on request by phoning 0407 935 998.

Soldiers Club continues support of Wellington Lions university scholarship scheme

FIRST YEAR and second year university students looking for a helpful hand in financing their university year can now apply for a share of seven monetary grants totalling \$25,000.

Wellington Lions Club is again facilitating the scholarship grants for 2026 offering five grants of \$3000 and two at \$5000 each.

This is the third year that Lions, assisted by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club, are continuing their “Scholarships to Stop the Brain Drain” program encouraging our locals to return to regional area after graduation.

The program won the education category of the 2024 Clubs NSW Community Awards and already 21 locals have

benefited from this scheme.

Applications opened on Monday and will close on Friday, February 27, so applicants need to act quickly.

Forms are available online at both the Wellington Lions and Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club websites while hard copies are available from the Soldiers Club office during business hours.

Successful applicants will be announced on March 6.

The grants are open to all locals living in the Wellington 2820 postcode areas including Geurie, Mumbil, Stuart Town and Yeoval and studying at a university outside a 100-kilometre radius of Wellington.

Applications must include a copy of the student’s HSC

certificate and a copy of the university’s acceptance letter, plus the local residential address.

Students must also write a short essay on what they are studying, and hope to gain from their studies, and their plans with their degree after graduation to work in a regional area.

Also an email address and contact number; their parents or guardians’ contact numbers.

Four Wellington judges – one from Lions, two from the Soldiers Club and an independent local businessperson – will select the seven successful students.

A grant will be made available through one payment to a real estate agent or the student’s university.



ABOVE: Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club director coordinating the scholarship grants Barry Jeffery, Lions president John Pringle and Soldiers Club General Manager Stephen Hodge at the program launch this week.

**Reopening
Sunday, 1st February
Empathetic Counselling
by Appointment 6845 4661**



Big weekend at Stuart Town

RECENTLY FORMED Stuart Town Preservation and History Society will be officially launched this Saturday while the town, Mumbil and Euchareena districts will celebrate Australia Day with another big bang on Monday, January 26.

The Preservation Society’s grand opening day will commence from 10am with the official ceremony about 11am at the Transaction Centre attached to the School of Arts Hall.

Also open for public inspection will be old Railway Hotel and Boehme’s Hall allowing visitors to step back in time and look through these historic buildings to glean some history of the

town originally named Ironbarks.

Monday’s Australia Day program begins at 8am in Moxon Park with a free barbecue breakfast with the Wellington Town Band.

The Award Ceremony will commence at 8.45am with 10 awards to be presented.

This will be followed with the cutting of the Australia Day cake with more musical entertainment from the Wellington Town band.

From 10am festivities turn to the Iron Bark Inn hotel featuring a Bike Show, Yabby races, pie eating contest, thong throwing and meat raffles.



Preservation & History Society poster.

Australian music will be played live from Moxon Park all day.

Farmers gearing up for fight

NSW FARMERS has engaged senior legal counsel as it ramps up opposition to the controversial Narrabri Gas Project.

Acting CEO Mike Guerin – who led a successful legal challenge against the federal government and mining giant Glencore in Queensland – said he was “getting the band back together” to fight Santos’ Narrabri Gas Project.

“NSW Farmers has engaged the same senior legal counsel we used to defeat the federal government and Glencore a couple of years ago, and we are actively exploring the best way to defend Australia’s precious groundwater from mining giants,” Mr Guerin said.

“The people who depend on the Great Arte-

sian Basin for their water are living in fear that this project will go ahead and go wrong, like many of them do, creating tens of thousands of water refugees and forcing farmers to abandon half the continent because it’s been contaminated forever.

“I’m happy to be getting the band back together on this one, because the risks with the Narrabri Gas Project are simply far too great to let it proceed.”

In 2024 Mr Guerin was CEO at Queensland farm organisation AgForce when it defeated the Australian Government and Glencore in a Federal Court case over a proposal to inject carbon dioxide into the Great Artesian Basin.

One of the key pieces of evidence was an expert independent hy-

drologist’s report, which found high risks of contaminating groundwater with high levels of arsenic and lead.

Mr Guerin called it a watershed moment for protection of vital groundwater, which was the only reliable source of clean water for almost half the nation.

“It’s a sad reality that governments, politicians and mining giants seem to be deaf to these genuine and real concerns about protecting this critical water source,” Mr Guerin said.

“They don’t appear to care about the environment or the communities that will be impacted or the billions of dollars’ worth of food that won’t be grown because of contamination.

“This is why organisations like NSW Farmers are here, to hold decision makers to account and make them do the right thing.”



Geurie Lions Markets - Saturday, January 31

Vic and Karol Howe celebrate 60th wedding anniversary

FAMILY AND friends from near and far helped Vic and Karol Howe celebrate their 60th wedding anniversary at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club's 75 on Arthur Restaurant last Saturday evening.

All their three children attended with their spouses while several of their eight grandchildren also attended.

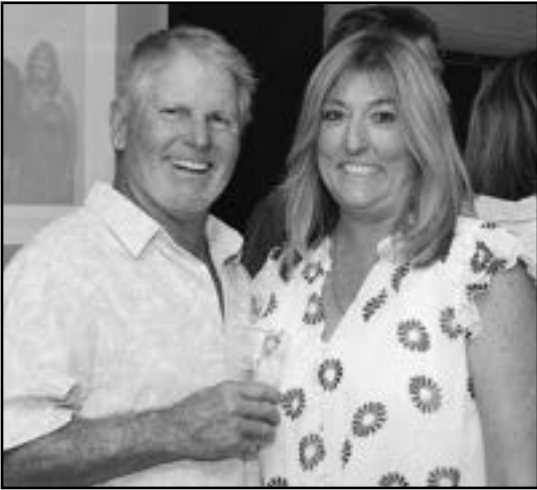
Vic and Karol also have three great-grandchildren.



Vic and Karol with son, Darryn and daughters Sonya and Fiona



Darryn and Tanya Howe, Mark Bennett and Fiona Groves, Vic and Karol, Sonya and Brett Berryman.



Wishing Clair Stiff the very best at Sydney Royal Show zone finals this February

WELLINGTON SHOW 2025 ‘Young Woman’, Clair Stiff has been busy promoting her passion - enlightening the region about Endometriosis.

As the Young Woman winner, Clair was invited with all state Young Women winners to attend a weekend development course at the Wesley Centre in Dubbo recently in preparation for the Sydney Royal Show Zone 6 finals to be held at Eugowra on February 28.

Back in last November Clair had the opportunity to speak about her condition as a guest speaker at an endometriosis girl’s night out at Gulgong RSL.

This was her first public speaking opportunity as Wellington’s Young Woman together with the condition’s research she is studying.

Clair said she was invited with another guest speaker and endo advocate, Brook Watts from Molong, who she said was very high up in the women’s ‘endo’ scene.

“We told our stories of our experience with ‘endo’ and I got to speak on the more clinical side as well as what my research is aiming for,” Clair said.

“Brook, who works with Youth in Ag, spoke about how the condition can affect work, and support services and the ‘Endo’ community that we have started to get going.

“From then I went and finished harvest with dad around the Wellington area.”

This was the first year all the Young Woman across the state (about 53) were invited, representing all the Sydney Young Woman competition zones.

It was a two-day development program over the week end with past Sydney Royal Show winners leading differing workshops on public speaking, etiquette, dress, networking, also history of Ag Shows NSW and ties to Sydney Royal Show and *The Land newspaper* – sponsored contest.

“The workshops were designed to prepare us for the zone judging coming up in a few weeks,” Clair said.

“We had a dinner on the Saturday evening, enabling us to connect with the girls in each zone so we don’t feel isolated when we attend zone finals.

“I think there will be 20 girls who will be in my Zone 6 and I was able to meet 18 of them.”

Clair said that it was interesting for her that all the girls were like-minded, but also different in their own way.

“We were given interview preparation, which helped take out the nerves, which was good,” Clair said.

“Having past winner taking us through the course was



All state Young Women show winners met in Dubbo for a development weekend.

good as we got an insight into their experiences and making it to Sydney.”

2026 Wellington 150th Show

Speaking of her experience so far, Clair said she thought this was one of the best opportunities she had been given.

“You kind of get to put your name out there a bit and represent your community which is amazing,” she said.

“I have been able to tie my research with the Young Woman Wellington title and put out my passion, my interest.

“And it’s a good opportunity to meet young women and go through the development programs that you are exposed to with the title.

“It’s a good opportunity to work with many of your skills, and even if you don’t make it to the state final or to Sydney, the experience and learning of skills along the way will help you through the rest of your life.”

Entries for the 2026 Wellington Show Young Woman competition will open shortly.

As the *Wellington & District Leader* is a strong supporter of the show and a sponsor of the Young Woman contest, we will be publishing more information as it comes to hand.



Brook Watts and Clair Stiff at the Gulgong “Endo” Girl’s Night Out.

Nature Spotters unearth Wellington’s natural wonders

DURING THESE school holidays a group of lucky locals became Nature Spotters.

Over one big week, participating students had the opportunity to go kayaking along the Macquarie (Wambuul) River, track down fossils on the Wellington Caves Fossil Trail, get up close and personal with a python, lizards and spiny leaf insects at a Reptile Show, explore Fern Gully and learn how to plant native seeds at the Burrendong Botanic Garden and Arboretum.

Nature Spotters is a program run by Mid Macquarie Landcare where children aged 8 to 14 get hands-on

experience with all the wonders of Wellington’s natural world.

At the end of last week one of the participants, Sophie Finn asked, “When is Nature Spotters on next? I can’t wait to do it again!”

Nature Spotters is set to run during Term 1 in Wellington.

The program consists of six sessions during the term with each session running for two hours one afternoon per week

For a small fee give your family member this great experience, email Mid Macquarie Landcare on info@mml.org.au or 0457 115 525 to book in.



Sophie Finn and Ryan Finn examine fossils during a lab session at Wellington Caves.

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36A Gisborne Street, Wellington



Gen Power, Sophie Finn, Charlotte Finn and Tim Finn plant native seeds at Burrendong Arboretum.

**Dugald Saunders**

Member for the Dubbo Electorate

Your voice for the Wellington District

Positions Vacant



We have a new position available for an **ADMINISTRATION ASSISTANT**
This position would suit a young person, maybe straight from high school, looking to establish a career in registered club administration.

Needs to be: Punctual, well presented, have typing skills and willing to participate in a TAFE Administration course.
Must hold an RSA and RCG or willing to obtain both.

**CONTACT: General Manager,
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
stephen@wellingtonsoldiers.com**

Trades & Services

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see Page 11
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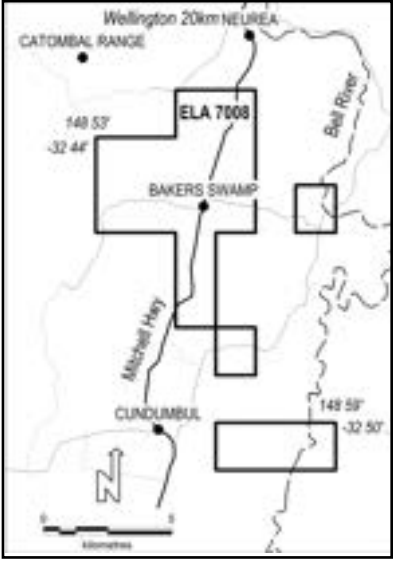
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Public Notice

Exploration licence application 7008

Notice is given in accordance with Section 13A of the Mining Act 1992 and clauses 15 and 89K of the Mining Regulation 2016 that exploration licence application number 7008 (Act 1992) for Group 1 minerals has been lodged with NSW Resources by Rally Resources Pty Ltd, ACN 649 547 615, over an area of about 49km2 which is located about 20km south of the town of Wellington, as described on the plan below. Information regarding this application can be obtained from Mark Arundell, phone number 0263654215, email rally@imex.au. Information regarding landholder's rights is available at <https://regional.nsw.gov.au/landholder-access>



Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town
Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel

2pm Sunday

Riverside Church Inc.

170 Thornton Street
Sunday: 10.00am Service
Thursday: Bible Study for Men and Women 10.30 am

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

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Annual General Meetings, Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

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Public Notice

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Around the electorate

with our State Member Dugald Saunders



Australia Day events

THERE ARE plenty of Australia Day events happening around the Dubbo electorate this long weekend, with some councils offering a yummy BBQ and others offering free entry to local pools, check out what’s happening closest to you and be a part of the celebration.

DUBBO - Sunday 25 January, from 7am at Victoria Park

WELLINGTON - Sunday 25 January, from 5pm at Cameron Park

STUART TOWN-MUMBIL-EUCHAREENA - Monday 26 January, from 8am at Moxam Park, Stuart Town

NARROMINE – Monday 26 January, from 7.30am at Dundas Park

TRANGIE - Monday 26 January, from 5.30pm at the Trangie Bowling Club

MUDGEES-GULGONG – Monday 26 January, from 8am at Rylstone Memorial Hall (Herbert Street, Rylstone)

And if you’re hitting the road this weekend, don’t forget that Double Demerits will apply from 12.01am Friday 23 January until 11.59pm Monday 26 January.

Summer Safety: Heatwaves

Heatwave warnings are common throughout our Aussie Summer.

Be prepared and follow these simple tips to have a healthy safe summer:

- * stay inside during the hottest part of the day
- * at home, close your curtains and use fans or air conditioning
- * do your housework or exercise early in the morning when it’s cooler
- * drink lots of water, even if you don’t feel thirsty
- * check in on family and friends regularly.

If you need medical advice and your usual doctor isn’t available, you can call health-direct anytime day or night, for free, on 1800 022 222 and get the help you need. For more tips on staying cool, visit: <https://www.health.nsw.gov.au/summer/Pages/default.aspx>

Kids Activity Vouchers

Eligible families in the Dubbo electorate

can apply now for the first Active and Creative Kids Voucher for 2026.

Families receiving?Family Tax Benefit through Services Australia?can apply for a \$50 voucher twice a year for each eligible child to help with the cost of active or creative activities with a registered provider.

Voucher 2 - 2025 can also be applied for and used with Voucher 1 - 2026 before 14 July 2026 for a combined value of \$100. To apply for a voucher or find a registered provider, visit: <https://www.service.nsw.gov.au/active-and-creative-kids-voucher>

2026 Training Awards

Applications for the 2026 NSW Training Awards are now open!

As the premier awards for vocational education and training (VET) in NSW, these awards are a great way for individuals, employers and Registered Training Organisations to receive recognition for outstanding achievements made possible through VET.

Individual nominations close 4pm, Mon-

day 2 February, while organisation nominations close 4pm, Friday 27 February. For more, visit: <https://education.nsw.gov.au/skills-nsw/nsw-training-awards>

Tertiary Student Scholarships

Students studying an accredited course through TAFE NSW, a Registered Training Organisation (RTO), University or a similar institution may be eligible to apply for financial assistance through OCTEC Limited’s Glenn Taylor Scholarship.

Valued up to \$20,000, this opportunity is designed to alleviate financial hardship for regional and rural Australian students.

Those living with disability, First Nations people, mature-aged students heading back to school, and people who have excelled in their studies are encouraged to apply.

Applications close February 28, 2026.

For more information, visit: <https://octec.org.au/glenntaylorscholarship/>

Until next time, Dugald

Andrew Gee votes against new gun laws

NEW GUN laws passed through federal parliament this week were voted against by the Federal Member for Calare, Andrew Gee.

Mr Gee argued his point during his speech on gun laws in the House of Representatives on Tuesday. A copy of his speech is published below.

Mr Gee, however, voted in favour of the *Combatting Antisemitism, Hate and Extremism (Criminal and Migration Laws)* Bill 2026.

This represents a comprehensive package of reforms which would further criminalise hateful conduct, and ensure that those who seek to spread hate, division and radicalisation are met with severe penalties.

Mr Gee said these reforms were necessary to address the rising levels of antisemitic and other hate speech, violence and extremism in Australia.

Mr Gee’s Hansard recording of his speech.

I am unable to support this bill, and I won’t be supporting this bill.

One of the issues that many in our electorate have is that this has been a political response to the horrific crime that was perpetrated on the 14th of December 2025.

Many have noted that the government’s first reaction to this atrocity was to call for firearm reform rather than a royal commission which would shine a light on exactly what happened here.

It smacked of a political response and the avoidance of scrutiny.

This has caused widespread anger amongst law-abiding gun owners in our region who believe that the government has unfairly targeted them, rather than uncovering all the facts that led to this evil crime.

One of the questions that many people in our communities have raised is how it is that terrorists were allowed to have access to licensed guns, by the New South Wales government, in circumstances where they were known to the federal security services as having links to extremists as far back as 2019.

They’re also asking questions such as why the terrorists’ recent trip to the Philippines didn’t raise any red flags.

Our police and security services do an extraordinary job

in keeping our community safe from threats that we never even hear about. We will never know how many attacks were prevented, but this one got through, and we need to know why so that we can stop it happening again.

I know that our communities are united in finding answers to these questions. However, the answers don’t lie in rushed legislation with no community consultation.

The only scrutiny of this legislation occurred through a committee process which the major parties exclude the crossbench from.

That’s right, the major parties unite to exclude the crossbench from the Joint Committee on Intelligence and Security, which is the parliamentary committee that ran a ridiculously brief inquiry into this legislation.

At the same time the sun is setting on their old political empires, they won’t even countenance crossbenchers on the committee that examines this very legislation.

The committee’s report was only made available minutes before this debate started, yet here we are voting on this bill. It’s breathtakingly arrogant and it makes a mockery of parliamentary processes.

In Calare, we have more than 17,000 firearm-licence holders. The government has rushed these changes through without giving our regional Australians the chance to have their say.

This is not the way to make good policy. We need to make sure that any changes to our gun laws are evidence-based and actually address the problems they are trying to solve.

The government’s current proposal fails this test. It’s a political response that unfairly targets law-abiding gun owners.

There are elements of the government’s proposed reforms that most people in our community would support and I do too.

These include the reforms to firearms background checks, which would enable Commonwealth intelligence to be shared and considered as part of firearms licensing decisions.

Most Australians would be surprised that this is not already occurring, and this is a failure of successive governments and the major parties.

I would also support the transmission of firearms infor-



mation between relevant stakeholders to facilitate a criminal intelligence assessment being made.

I do, however, remain concerned about the consequences of a number of measures in the bill and the potential unintended consequences for law-abiding gun owners, including farmers, veterans, professional shooters, members of our community gun clubs and local businesses.

This is no John Howard-style gun buyback, and the flaws in the compensation arrangements are there for all to see, particularly for legitimate, law-abiding firearms businesses.

The undeniable fact is that criminals are not the ones that are going to be handing in firearms as part of a buyback.

What our communities would like to see is a comprehensive national effort to tackle illegal firearms and the trade in them.

Sadly, the government did not take the time to consult with regional communities and rushed this legislation out while at the same time resisting a royal commission until the weight of public opinion simply became too great.

I will continue to stand up for law-abiding gun owners in the Central West, and I will continue to hold the government to account on this issue.

Unfortunately, this rushed response was born out of a desire to avoid the scrutiny of a royal commission.

Everyone in our region supports genuine measures to make our community safer, but we need a response that is based on evidence and facts, and not politics.

This should be the government’s priority, not targeting law-abiding citizens.

Shaping the future of NSW Cemeteries

The state government is calling on cemetery operators and communities to help shape the future of cemeteries and memorial parks across the state, with the release of the draft Perpetual Care Framework for public consultation.

Cemeteries and memorial parks are more than resting places, they are spaces for remembrance, reflection, and community connection.

The draft Perpetual Care Framework sets

out a plan to ensure these special places are cared for, respected, and accessible for generations to come.

The proposed framework will:

- * Provide a clear definition of what is meant by perpetual care,
- * Provide opportunities to keep cemeteries as vibrant and valuable spaces into the future, even when they have reached full capacity,
- * Hold cemetery operators accountable for

perpetual care and ensure ongoing safe access for families and communities

- * Give families certainty that cemeteries will be maintained with dignity and respect, even after they are no longer active
- * Manage maintenance costs most effectively through long term planning
- * Respect the diverse religious and cultural needs of NSW communities
- * Allow for innovative and respectful uses for cemeteries, such as new green spaces,

so these valued places can continue to benefit the community in new ways.

The draft Perpetual Care Framework shares real-world examples of what a well-planned approach to perpetual care can look like in practice, citing the Melbourne General Cemetery in central Melbourne, and Camperdown Memorial Rest Park in Sydney as alternative approaches.



with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**



“BELIEVE NOTHING you hear, and only one half that you see.”

That line was written in 1845 by Edgar Allan Poe, long before electricity was common, let alone the internet.

Yet if Poe were somehow peering back at us from the future, he might feel uncomfortably vindicated by how 2025 played out.

When people look back on last year from a decade or two ahead, there will be plenty of candidates for “the big tech story”.

Many will point to the under-16 social media ban as a defining moment - a line in the sand where society finally admitted that always-on digital life might not be great for developing minds.

It is a significant shift, but it’s also very much a work in progress. From a global perspective, this debate is only just beginning, and the rules are far from settled.

To my mind, though, the real story of 2025 was the year two powerful technologies stopped feeling futuristic and started feeling normal. The first is artificial intelligence.

AI didn’t arrive in 2025 - it had been building for years - but this was the year it truly faded into the background.

It began turning up everywhere: helping write emails, summarise meetings, plan holidays, answer customer service questions and even assist kids with homework.

For many people, AI stopped being “that clever thing tech companies talk about” and became more like spellcheck or GPS.

You might not love it, but you use it.

That normalisation is precisely what makes Poe’s quote feel so relevant.

In 1845, “believe only half of what you see” was a warning about human trickery.

In 2025, it’s a warning about machines that can generate photos, videos and voices that look and sound convincingly real.

It’s no longer just gossip you can’t trust; it’s images, recordings and screenshots.

When seeing is no longer believing, society is forced to rethink trust from the ground up.

Governments, understandably, are struggling to keep pace.

Regulation moves slowly; AI evolves at

software speed.

Laws written for a pre-AI world now find themselves stretched, patched and occasionally broken. That tension - between innovation and oversight - will define the next decade, but 2025 was when it became impossible to ignore.

The second big story of the year was the electric vehicle quietly growing up.

For years, EV conversations followed a familiar script: too expensive, too hard to charge, not practical, maybe someday.

In 2025, that “someday” edged closer to “maybe”. More models arrived at more realistic prices. Range anxiety eased. Charging networks expanded.

The arguments didn’t disappear, but they softened.

Perhaps the clearest sign of this shift came not from drivers, but from buildings.

Strata managers who once said “never” to chargers in underground car parks began asking a very different question: “How many will we need?”

That’s what normalisation looks like. The

debate moves from whether a technology belongs, to how to accommodate it.

What ties AI and electric vehicles together is not hype, but maturity.

Both technologies are moving out of their awkward teenage years. They’re no longer novelties to marvel at or fear outright. They’re becoming part of the fabric of daily life, forcing society to adapt.

That’s likely how the future will remember 2025. Not as the year of one dramatic breakthrough, but as the year technology started behaving like an adult - powerful, imperfect, and deeply embedded in how we live.

Poe warned us to be sceptical of our senses. In a world shaped by AI and electrification, that advice feels less like poetry and more like practical guidance.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first ten e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get involved, get a freebie!

THURSDAY, JANUARY 22, 2026, 7

5x5 No. 375

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

B	A	T
	O	E
U	A	E
	E	U
B	E	D

Edgeword No. 227

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

TE

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There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath No. 225

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

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HIWSSOR3



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Maggie Beer's Big Mission. **1.30** Gardening Australia. **2.30** Muster Dogs: Where Are They Now. Final. **3.15** The Assembly. **4.00** Poh's Kitchen On The Road. **4.30** Amanda & Alan's Italian Job. **5.00** Antiques Roadshow. **6.00** Grand Designs Transformations. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Australian Of The Year 2026. **8.45** The ABC Of. **9.15** The Jetty. Final. **10.20** Call The Midwife. **11.20** MOVIE: Wake In Fright. (1971) **1.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Harry's Practice. **2.00** South Aussie With Cosi. **2.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **3.30** Medical Emergency. **4.00** The Amazing Homemakers. **5.00** Secrets Of Beautiful Gardens. **6.00** Escape To The Country. **7.00** The Vicar Of Dibley. **8.30** Vera. **10.30** Murdoch Mysteries. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.35** Whose Line Is It Anyway? **3.00** Heartbreak High. **3.45** Would I Lie To You? **4.15** MythBusters. **5.10** Car S.O.S. **6.00** Grand Designs Transformations. **7.00** QI. **7.30** Would I Lie To You? **8.05** The Piano UK. Return. **8.55** Louis Theroux: Extreme Love. **9.55** ER. **10.40** Late Programs.



6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** MOVIE: City Slickers II. (1994) **2.30** Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. **3.30** Better Homes And Gardens Summer. **4.30** Cows For Cambodia. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Cricket: Big Bash League: The Final. **10.30** Big Bash League Post-Game. **11.00** 7NEWS Spotlight. **12.00** Cycling. Santos Tour Down Under. Men's. Stage 5. Highlights. **1.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **4.30** Deep Water Salvage. **5.30** Counting Cars. **6.00** Border Security: International. **7.00** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **8.30** MOVIE: The Bourne Ultimatum. (2007) Matt Damon, Julia Stiles, David Strathairn. **10.50** MOVIE: The Scorpion King. (2002) **12.50** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **10.00** MOVIE: Thomas And Friends: The Mystery Of Lookout Mountain. (2022) **11.00** Kids' Programs. **6.50** Andy And The Band. **7.05** Pirlipenguins. **7.30** Shaun Tan's Tales From Outer Suburbia. **7.55** MOVIE: Spy Kids 3: Game Over. (2003) **9.15** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.00** Merlin. **10.45** Late Programs.



6.00 Hello SA. **6.30** Explore TV: Trade Routes Of The Middle Ages. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Australian Open Tennis Pre-Show. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Day 8. **4.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Afternoon 8. **6.00 9News Sunday.** **7.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Night 8. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Late Night 8. **12.00** The First 48. **1.00** Next Stop. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** GolfBarons. **5.00** Today Early News. **5.30** Today.



6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Arty. **8.30** Flushed. **10.00** Zumbo's Just Desserts. **12.30** Home And Away. **3.30** Cats Make You Laugh Out Loud. **4.30** Puppy School. **5.30** The Conners. **6.30** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. **7.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **8.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **12.30** Grimm. **3.00** Covert Affairs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Culture By Design. **3.00** News. **3.30** Play On. **4.00** News. **4.30** Landline. **5.00** News. **5.30** Regional Roundup. **6.00** Evening News. **6.30** The Whillam Dismissal: 50 Years On. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Australian Of The Year 2026. **8.45** News Tonight. **9.00** Nightly News. **9.30** Heywire. **10.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Intrepid Adventures. **8.00** What's Up Down Under. **8.30** Buy To Build. **9.00** Key Ingredient. **9.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **11.00** Mixed Martial Arts. UFC 324: Gaethje vs Pimblett. Prelims. **1.00** Deal Or No Deal. **1.30** Lingo. **2.30** Basketball. NBL. Round 18. Sydney Kings v Adelaide 36ers. **4.30** Deal Or No Deal. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** 10 News+. **7.00** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **8.30** NCIS: Sydney. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. Return. **10.30** NCIS: Origins. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Tough Tested. **9.00** What's Up Down Under. **9.30** Camper Deals. **10.00** Navigating The World. **11.00** JAG. **4.00** iFISH. **4.30** Basketball. NBL. Round 18. Perth Wildcats v Melbourne United. **6.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** FBI: Most Wanted. **11.15** FBI: International. **12.15** Home Shopping.



6.00 Morning Programs. **9.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **10.00** Australian Open Tennis Pre-Show. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Day 8. **6.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Night 8. **8.00** M*A*S*H. **8.30** MOVIE: A Bridge Too Far. (1977) Sean Connery, Robert Redford, Gene Hackman. **12.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **1.00** Speedweek. **3.00** Motor Racing. Best of Dakar Rally. iFlights. **4.00** Figure Skating. ISU European Cships. Part Two. iFlights. **5.35** Our Tiny Islands. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Once Upon A Time In Space. **9.30** Pompeii: The Last Mysteries Revealed. **10.20** Putin And The West: The Next Chapter. **11.30** Black Gold. **1.05** Building The Impossible. **2.00** Rise Of The Nazis: The Downfall. **3.10** 24 Hours In Emergency. **4.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Deal Or No Deal. **8.00** Frasier. **11.00** The Neighborhood. **11.30** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **2.30** Friends. **6.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** South Park. **12.30** Home Shopping. **1.30** South Park. **2.30** Home Shopping.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Mastermind Australia. **3.00** Heroines. **4.00** WorldWatch. **5.30** Cycling. ProVelo Super League. SA Kick It. **8.30** Irresistible: Why We Can't Stop Eating. **10.15** The Grudge. **11.45** The Gentle Art Of Swedish Death Cleaning. **2.45** NHK World English News. **5.00** Al Jazeera Newshour.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Great Australian Bee Challenge. **2.00** Restoration Australia. **2.55** Would I Lie To You? **3.25** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.50** Grand Designs: House Of The Year. **4.40** Long Lost Family. **5.25** Antiques Roadshow. **6.25** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Australia Day Live. **9.30** Hard Quiz: Battle Of The Has Beens. **10.10** Dr Karl's How Things Work. **10.40** ABC Late News. **10.55** The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. **11.25** Grand Designs: House Of The Year. **12.15** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Australia: The Story Of Us. **2.00** Weekender. **2.30** This Rugged Coast. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Doc Martin. **8.30** Endeavour. **10.30** Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.10** ER. **2.55** Heartbreak High. **3.40** Would I Lie To You? **4.10** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Penn & Teller: Foot Us. **9.15** Whose Line Is It Anyway? **9.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** MOVIE: Nikki And Nora: Sister Sleuths. (2022) **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The 1% Club UK: Rollover. **8.30** 9-1-1. **10.30** Crime Investigation Australia: Most Infamous. **12.00** Girlfriends' Guide To Divorce. **1.00** Conviction. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** NFL Tailgate. **3.00** Boating. Circuit Boats Drivers C'ship. Windsor Spectacular. **4.00** Counting Cars. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **9.30** Aussie Salvage Squad. **10.30** Mighty Planes. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.15** Andy's Aquatic Adventures. **4.40** Vida The Vet. **5.40** Kangaroo Beach. **6.05** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.30** TKO: Total Knock Out. **9.10** The Crystal Maze. **9.55** Merlin. **10.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Today. **10.00** Australian Open Tennis Pre-Show. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Day 9. **4.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Afternoon 9. **6.00 9News.** **7.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Night 9. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Late Night 9. **12.00** Chicago Med. **1.00** Next Stop. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** GolfBarons. **5.00** Today Early News. **5.30** Today.



6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Arty. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Plate Of Origin. **12.00** The Amazing Race. **3.00** Dodge. **4.00** Lopez Vs. Lopez. **4.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **8.30** Law & Order: SVU. **9.30** Bones. **11.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **12.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** ABC News Day. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** ABC News Summer. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** Back Roads. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.30** Australian Story. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** 7.30 Special. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Farm To Fork. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **9.00** Matlock. **10.00** 10's Late News. **10.30** 10 News+. **11.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **12.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Reel Action. **8.30** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** A Million Little Things. **2.30** JAG. **4.30** The Living Room. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** FBI: Most Wanted. **11.15** FBI: International. **12.15** Home Shopping.



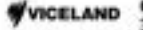
6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Thunderbirds. **8.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **9.30** Newstyle Direct. **10.00** Australian Open Tennis Pre-Show. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Day 9. **6.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Night 9. **8.00** Death In Paradise. **9.00** The Chelsea Detective. **11.00** London Kills. **12.00** Late Programs.



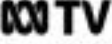
6.00 Morning Programs. **12.05** WorldWatch. **2.10** Going Places. **2.45** The Cook Up With Adam Liew. **3.17** Ocean Wreck Investigation. **4.03** Jeopardy! **4.30** Letters And Numbers. **5.00** Mastermind Australia. **5.30** NiTV News Special: Day 26 2026. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** The Colliano Heart. **9.10** Stock Aitken Waterman: Legends Of Pop. **10.25** SBS World News Late. **10.55** Like Water For Chocolate. **11.50** Clean Sweep. **1.50** Pagan Peak. **3.35** Craig & Bruno's Great British Road Trips. **4.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.20** Mastermind Aust. **3.50** WorldWatch. **5.50** Lost Gold Of The Aztecs. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** James May And The Dull Men. **9.25** Under The Banner Of Heaven. **10.40** MOVIE: The New Boy. (2023) **12.50** Dark Side Of The Cage. **1.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **11.00** Human. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Call The Midwife. **2.00** Restoration Australia. **3.00** Would I Lie To You? **3.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.55** Grand Designs: House Of The Year. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Dr Karl's How Things Work. **8.30** Human. **9.30** Grand Designs Transformations. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Whiteley Art Scandal. Final. **11.45** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Creek To Coast. **2.30** Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Call The Midwife. **8.45** Judge John Deed. **10.45** Miniseries: Midnight Man. **11.45** Late Programs.



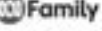
6.00 Morning Programs. **2.25** Heartbreak High. **3.10** A Bite To Eat. **3.40** Would I Lie To You? **4.10** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** Richard Osman's House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Fisk. **9.30** Elementary. **10.55** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** MOVIE: For Love And Honor. (2016) **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The 1% Club UK: Rollover. **8.30** Doc. **10.30** St. Denis Medical. **11.30** Autopsy USA. **12.30** MOVIE: A Jealous Friendship. (2021) **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **11.00** Storage Wars. **11.30** American Pickers. **12.30** Pawn Stars. **1.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **3.30** Tougher In Alaska. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **9.30** Railroad Australia. **10.30** Ice Road Truckers. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.15** Andy's Aquatic Adventures. **4.40** Vida The Vet. **5.40** Kangaroo Beach. **6.05** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.30** Hippo Watch With Steve Backshall. **9.15** Planet Weird. **10.05** Merlin. **10.50** Late Programs.



6.00 Today. **10.00** Australian Open Tennis Pre-Show. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Day 10. **4.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Afternoon 10. **6.00 9News.** **7.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Night 10. **11.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Late Night 10. **12.00** Chicago Med. **1.00** Next Stop. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Destination WA. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** GolfBarons. **5.00** Today Early News. **5.30** Today.



6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Arty. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Plate Of Origin. **12.00** The Amazing Race. **3.00** Dodge. **4.00** Lopez Vs. Lopez. **4.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **9.30** CSI: Miami. **11.30** CSI: New York. **12.30** Grimm. **3.00** Covert Affairs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** ABC News Day. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** ABC News Summer. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.30** Australian Story. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** 7.30. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Farm To Fork. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **9.00** Matlock. **10.00** 10's Late News. **10.30** 10 News+. **11.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **12.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Reel Action. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** A Million Little Things. **2.30** JAG. **4.30** The Living Room. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** FBI: International. **10.20** FBI: Most Wanted. **11.15** A Million Little Things. **12.15** Home Shopping.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Antiques Roadshow. **2.30** MOVIE: Carry On Cabby. (1963) **4.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.00** Tennis. Australian Open. Afternoon 11. **7.00** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** New Tricks. **8.40** Agatha Christie's Marple. **10.40** Miniseries: Agatha Christie's The Pale Horse. **11.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** Auschwitz: The Hidden Traces. **3.00** Going Places. **3.35** The Cook Up With Adam Liew. **4.05** Inferno: Letters From Auschwitz. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Who Do You Think You Are? **8.30** Portillo's 200 Years Of The Railways. **9.40** Aerial Australia. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Exit. **11.55** DNA. **1.40** 24 Hours In Emergency. **2.30** 24 Hours In A&E. **3.25** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.



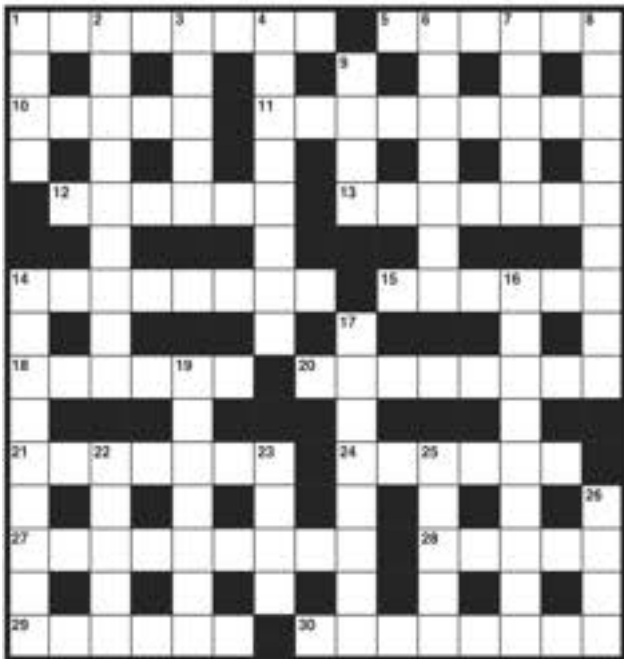
6.00 Morning Programs. **2.20** Mastermind Aust. **3.20** Kars & Stars. **3.50** WorldWatch. **5.50** Lost Gold Of The Aztecs. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** James May And The Dull Men. **9.25** Under The Banner Of Heaven. **10.35** Caskeeters Life & Death Across The Globe. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.05** Meet The Penguins. **11.10** All Creatures Great And Small. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** To Be Advised. **1.00** Miniseries: The Cry. Final. **1.55** Restoration Australia. **2.55** Would I Lie To You? **3**

CROSSWORD

No. 160



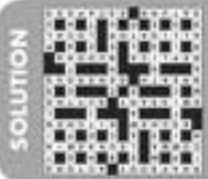
- 24 Siddhartha Gautama (6)
27 Dangerous aquatic reptile (9)
28 Confined to an area (5)
29 A planet (6)
30 Prison-breakers (8)

DOWN

- 1 Wealthy (4)
2 Truce (9)
3 Breakd (5)
4 Small US state (8)
6 In a state of disorder (7)
7 Activeness, effort (5)
8 Type of steel (9)
9 Male deer (4)
14 Humiliate (9)
16 Dental soreness (9)
17 Hound of Hades (8)
19 Lever setting off a gun (7)
22 Flyer (5)
23 Singing voice (4)
25 Greek letter (5)
26 Additional (4)

ACROSS

- 1 Bliss (8)
5 Thesplans (6)
10 Punctuation mark (5)
11 Cancer of the blood-forming tissues (9)
12 Shun (6)
13 Galley (7)
14 Diplomatic representative sent on a mission (8)
15 Mowing tool (6)
18 From the mouth (5)
20 Giving (8)
21 Reproduction (7)

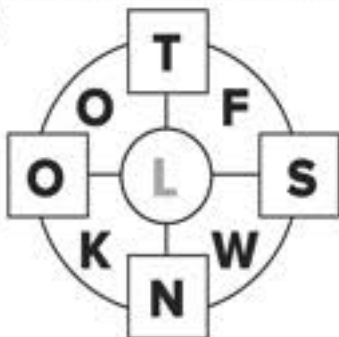


9-LETTER

No. 160

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
14 words: Good
21 words: Very good
28 words: Excellent



WOLF, WOOL
TOWNSFOLK, WOOL
SOLO, STOLE, TOLL, TOOLS
LOAF, LOAMS, SLOW, SLOW
LOAN, LOAN, LOAN, LOAN
LOFT, LOFT, LOOK, LOOKS
FOOL, FOOL, FOWL, FOWLS
FLOW, FLOW, FLOW, FLOW

CODEWORD

No. 110

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

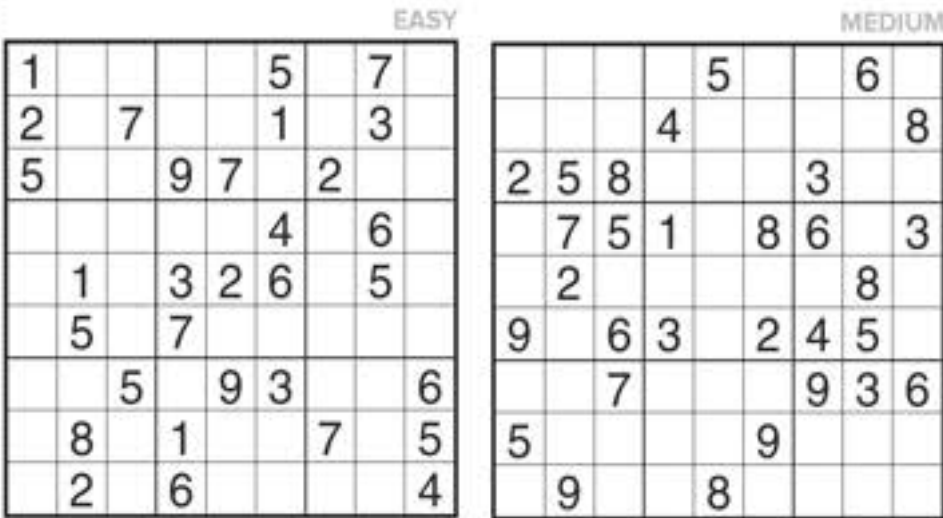


SOLUTIONS: 1. L, 2. Z, 3. L, 4. L, 5. L, 6. L, 7. L, 8. L, 9. L, 10. L, 11. L, 12. L, 13. L, 14. L, 15. L, 16. L, 17. L, 18. L, 19. L, 20. L, 21. L, 22. L, 23. L, 24. L, 25. L, 26. Z

SUDOKU

No. 160

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



QUICK QUIZ

1. What class of animal is a quokka?
2. How long is a half in a game of handball?
3. Is Tully north or south of Cairns?
4. Porcelain, Horseshoe and King are all types of what?
5. True or false: some species of squids can 'fly' for short distances out of the water?
6. In which US state is the presidential retreat Camp David?
7. When referring to cameras, what does SLR stand for?
8. Jemaine Clement (pictured) voices which character in the Disney film Moana?
9. Who directed the films 300 and Watchmen?
10. What is the largest city in Bolivia?



Snyder 10, Santa Cruz

WORD SEARCH

No. 070

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- AQUAVIT
BEER
CIDER
COCOA
COKE
COLA
CONGO
CREAM
DRAMBUIE
ELIXIR
FLIP
KAVA
KUMMEL
KVASS
LAGER
LIQUEUR
LIQUOR
MACON
MADEIRA
MEAD
MICKEY FINN
MLK
NEGUS
OOLONG
PEKOE
PORT
POTEEEN
PUNCH
RATAFIA
RED WINE
RETSINA
RICKEY
ROSE
RYE
WHISKEY
SACK
SAKE
SAKI
SHRUB
STOUT
TEA
TODDY
TOKAY
TONIC
WHISKY

SECRET MESSAGE: Raise your glasses and toast to the future

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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

For More Information
call



Mb: 0428 635 994

ANOTHER HOT and dry week, a lot of thunder with little rain here at the house 25mm in total.

Our thoughts and prayers go out to those affected by fires and floods

Spray now, profit later

Investing time and money in controlling summer weeds boasts next season’s prospects. Some of our local weeds such as catheads, barnyard grass, windmill grass, panic grass, fleabane, Bathurst burrs, camel melons, sourthistle plus more. Summer weed management can lead to direct yield increases through 1. Increased plant available water. 2. A wider and more reliable sowing window. 3. Higher levels of plant available nitrogen. 4. Reduced levels of weed-vectored diseases and nematodes. 5. Reduced levels of rust inoculum via the interruption of the green bridge. 6. Reduced levels of diseases vectored by aphids that build in numbers on summer weeds. 7. Reduced physical impacts from weeds on crop establishment.

Chemical control

Glyphosate remains the most critical herbicide for controlling weeds in the summer fallow, however glyphosate resistance and certain environmental factors can reduce its performance. Glyphosate relies on translocation to the roots and shoot tips.

Applying it to stressed plants or large plants may reduce translocation and efficacy. A double knock-down strategy is the best option for summer weed control, especially for hard to kill weeds. Maximise glyphosate efficiency by 1. Apply under optimal conditions 2. Using coarse to very coarse nozzles means larger droplets allowing more time for glyphosate to enter the leaf due to slower droplet evaporation.

Remember always use the maximum rate and add ammonium sulphate and clean palatable water. Do the second knock around 7 to 10 days later with sprayseed.

Markets at a glance

WOOL. EMI closed at 1648c/kg clean, up 107c from 37065 bales. Sydney Merino fleece with good strength (>38n/ktex) contributed to price gains across all MPG’s. Merino skirtings, broken lines continue to be keenly sought after gaining upwards of 90c. Oddments: Locks, crutchings and stains all lifted the NRI closed 1692c/kg clean, up 117c Sydney’s pass-in 0.4% with 177 bales withdrawn.

CATTLE: Carcoar CTLX 13th.3419 cattle. Cattle suitable for feeders and restockers well supplied, good lines of well finished cattle, cows and grown cattle also in large numbers. Prime yearling steers 420c to 470 c/kg, yearling heifers 370c to 441c/kg. Feeder steers 438c to 500c/kg, heifers 380c to 470c/kg. Steers to restockers 442c, heifers to 455c/kg. Grown steers sold from 390c to 478c, heifers ,362c to 467c/kg. Cows sold, 2 & 3 scores 200c to 396c, heavy cows 392c to 408c/kg. Heavy bulls to 414c/kg.

SHEEP: CTLX 14th. 4923 sheep (+3333) 5103 lambs (+1613. Market cheaper. Light processing lambs to 18kg \$110 to \$200. Trade 20kg to 24kg \$200 to \$250. Heavy over 24kg \$230 to \$288. Carcase prices ave 960c to 1020c/kg cwt. Light lambs to restockers to \$224. Heavy hoggets to \$250.Mutton dearer trend. Merino ewes to \$218. XB ewes \$138 to \$285. Merino wethers \$178 to \$212. Xbred wethers and rams to \$150. Most sheep ranged 760c to 820c/kg cwt.

Merch stocks to clear

Glyphosate quick acting 20lt \$195, Sprayseed 20lt \$180. Fert 25kg SOA \$22. MAP \$24. DAP \$26.



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Livestock and Property
Pty Limited

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE yarded 8040, increase of 4700. Much plainer yarding, Limited numbers of young trade cattle and cheaper with vealers and yearlings selling 374c to 439c/kg. Feeder steers 10c dearer, feeder heifers 15c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 382c to 518c, heifers 356c to 456c/kg. Young restocker cattle dealer with young steers to 538c, heifers to 416c/kg. Grown steers 6c dearer, heifers 11c to 14c/kg cheaper. Grown steers 434c to 474c, heifers 410c to 440c/kg. Secondary cows close to firm, heavy weights 15c/ kg cheaper. Two and 3 score cows to processors 280c to 390c, heavy cows 370c to 406c, ave 395c/kg. Cows to restockers 245c to 410c/kg.

Dubbo Lamb sale yarded 15,305. Quality mixed, large supplies of lightweight secondary lambs, limited trade weights, good runs of finished heavy lambs. All regular buyers operating. Light processing lambs to 18kg held firm, \$130 to \$198. Trade lambs 20kg to 24Kg lifted \$5 to \$10, \$215 to \$260, ave 1010c to 1050c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs over 24kg \$10 stronger, selling from \$238 to \$324, ave 1040c/kg cwt. Merino lambs \$118 to \$256, heavy hoggets to \$295.

Mutton. 12,681 mixed quality yarded, prices strong. Merino ewes \$96 to \$260, crossbred ewes \$128 to \$291. Merino wethers \$148 to \$235, crossbred wethers to \$309. Heavy rams to \$171. Most sheep range 800c to 850c/kg cwt.

Dubbo Store Cattle yarded 1595. Mostly medium weight weaner cattle. Small buying group, prices held firm.

Lightweight weaner steers to 200kg \$700 to \$1120, to 574c/kg. Medium steers \$960 to \$1570, ave 500c/kg. Heavy over 330kg \$1430 to \$1750. Light weaner heifers \$460 to \$940, or 470c/kg. Angus heifers, 200kg to 330kg, \$700 to \$1360, ave 409c/kg, heavies \$1250 to \$1450. Yearling steers to \$1660, steers to feed to \$1880 or 450c/kg. Yearling heifers to \$1790. Cows with calves, quality mixed, \$1650 to \$2470.

Wool. Auctions returned setting a blistering pace. History tells us that we rarely see a selling week stronger than this. Prices dearer on Tuesday’s opening, NRI gaining 74 cents. The market gained a further 43 cents on final day to at its highest level since January 2020. All types and categories well supported with the largest rises in the 18.5 to 19.5 micron types. 36,585 bales sold with an almost non-existent passed-in rate of just 1.3%. Major buyers included Techwool, PJ Morris and Sequoia with widespread support from the trade. The surge has led to an increase in this week’s offering of 43,000+ bales expected. To put that in context is important because the same sale last season was a 50,000 bale offering. AWTA test data for the first half of the season is showing an 8.4% reduction in the weight of wool tested nationally. The Australian Wool Production Forecasting Committee released an update to its 2025/26 estimate during the recess with a 12.6% decline in production expected. Concerns about upcoming supply availability would be at the forefront of the mind for most in the trade.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending January 16, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

WOOL INDEX	This Week 5/19/25	This Week 12/16/25	Last Sale 5/25/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2250	2242	2108	+92	1731	+519
18	2967	2957	2942	+125	1994	+973
19	2071	2042	1818	+153	1478	+593
20	1980	1991	-	-	1830	+150
21	-	1916	-	-	-	-
22	-	818	743	-	-	-
23	980	985	950	+30	925	+55
MAC	988	930	807	+81	728	+260

Hang on to your hat

WHILST WE reported that the final sale prior to Christmas was unspectacular, we can report quite the opposite this week! The reasonable offering of 37,065 bales saw only 1.3% passed-in comprising mostly of XB oddments like dags or similar. The Merino fleece sector was on fire from the opening lot, and both days saw continued improvement with the Western Indicator (which is all Merino) posting the largest gain of 133 cents to finish at 1846 cents clean. This was the 8th largest weekly rise since 1988 and the best start to a calendar year since 2011. Whilst all categories had favourable support, low VM, high yielding wools particularly with good CV length and strength figures benefited most. Buyer support flowed over into the XB sector and carding sector with both categories rising by 40 cents. It was only a matter of weeks back that XB lambs’ wool lines were flat out to average \$500 a bale and now it’s more like \$750 a bale. Fine XB lambs’ wool around 22 microns will make double what the broader 28/29-micron X LMS will make. The question everyone is asking is “how far will this go?” And of course, at the pace it rose last week

one tends to be a bit nervous. This week’s sale is expecting 43,326 bales which will test competition but with the latest data from AWTA reporting a 8.3% reduction year on year equating to around 71,000 bales, or two selling weeks gone from supply. What we know for certain is that production just can’t rise to meet demand in the short to medium term. Quite a lot of wool growing areas are very dry and production will still fall despite strong prices. The saviour during the drought of 2018/19 was the price of wool and perhaps we may be lucky enough again to have this going in the favour of those growers towing a feed cart. There will be debate whether this current rise is demand driven or supply driven, and it would be good to think it’s more demand driven. I suspect it’s a bit of both as the fear of the US Tariffs effect wanes and downstream players gain confidence, but as we move past the peak Summer/Autumn shearing season and the drop in production continues, the post Easter period could be interesting.

Macwool and Carmichael offered 1779 bales on Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Cowra

LESS THAN five months since commencing his race riding career, apprentice jockey Jacob Stiff has already won two Central West feature races, the Mudgee Cup for trainer Cameron Crockett in December and on Sunday, the Cowra Cup aboard the Michael Mulholland trained Shadow Dane.

Jacob Stiff (18) is apprenticed at Dubbo to Michael Mulholland who had the \$4.40 second favourite Talkachino and the \$11 chance Shadow Dane in the \$36,000 Breakout River Meats Cowra Cup, over 1700 metres.

Talkachino was coming off successive wins at Tamworth and Orange however did not threaten on Sunday while Shadow Dane hit top form.

Producing a powerful run from well back in the big field, Shadow Dane swept down the outside to win the Cup by a half-length from the Michael Travers, Wagga Wagga trained pair Mathrin (Adrian Layt, \$31) and Dynamic One (Molly Bourke, \$8).

The 1200m Cowra Lamb-Cowra Japan Cup (1200) is always a popular event and a capacity field of sprinters lined up on Sunday.

Last start Orange winner, the Gary Nickson, Warwick Farm trained Zale as the \$3 favourite justified punters confidence with a dashing display.

Overcoming a near outside barrier, Zale (Molly Bourke) began quickly and led throughout to score by over two lengths from Acheson (Jessica Brookes, \$26) and Hellinda (Rochelle Wedrat-Kroezen, \$6.50).

Inaugural staging of the 1200m Jeffs Joinery-John Jeffs Memorial-Benchmark 58 Handicap saw an impressive win by the Gratz Vella, Canberra trained Wonderful Mistake.

Getting close to home, Wonderful Mistake (Damon Budler, \$3.60 fav) pounced on the leading pack and won by a neck from Our Little Star (Zac Wadick, \$4.20) and Can Do It (Robyn Freeman, \$17).

The 950m Markey Saddlery-Reg & Rose Paine Memorial-Benchmark 58 Handicap was also run for the first time and the Marc Chevalier, Hawkesbury trained Kev’s Girl (Claire Ramsbotham, \$4.40) from a wide gate led all the way to beat Bolo Miss (Mathew Cahill, \$4.20 fav) and Desirous (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$6.50).

Making it three wins from the last five starts, the Clint Lundholm, Dubbo trained Beauty Edge (Zoe Hunt, \$6.50) established a nice lead in the 1200m Cowra Motors -Benchmark 58 Handicap and held on well to account for Deepwater Artist (Billy Owen, \$2.25 fav) and Soho Sushi (Adrian Layt, \$5).

Following in the footsteps of his father Craig Hyeronimus (President) and mother Narelle Hyeronimus (Secretary), Jason Hyeronimus is the new President of Cowra Jockey Club and he would have been very pleased with the big crowd on Cup day.

Cowra will next race on Monday, March 9 and Parkes will race this Saturday and Bathurst on Friday, January 30.



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Wellington Soldiers Memorial and Golf Club is Celebrating its 100 year anniversary on Sunday, March 15, and a four-person Ambrose will be the feature competition of the day.

Nominations close on Sunday, March 8 and cost for the day is \$50 which includes breakfast and lunch

Last Saturday’s events were an Individual Stableford plus Round 7 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition.

Winner of the day was Nate Conn who finished with a great score of 45pts.

Runner-up also with a great score was Joe Ryan with 41pts.

Prize winners were Matt Conn 40pts; Reid Armstrong, Harrison Pilon from Dubbo, Jamie Robertson, Brad Conn 39pts; Bryan Kiss 38pts; Paul West, Jeremy Barton, Gary Cusack, Gary McCarroll, Andrew Long from Dubbo, Rod Miller 37pts; Garth Watts from Dubbo, Doug Ney 36pts, Adam Ryan, Liam Conn, Matt Reid 35pts.

Nearest the pin on the 3rd Bryan Kiss, 8th Jordan Disney, 14th Malcolm Payne, 16th David Wilson.

Jespresso Cafe longest drives went to

Golf club’s 100th anniversary celebrations coming soon

Matt Reid in A grade and Gary McCarroll in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by Rob Parnell who whacked the ball more times than he would have liked, final score 24pts.

Wednesday’s ladies golf day play was an Individual Stableford while a nine-hole competition was also played.

Winner was Adam Ferguson from Gulgong with 34pts on a countback with runner-up being Josef Hanson from Mudgee with 34pts.

Prize winner was Lindsay Dawes 31pts on a countback.

Thursday’s Individual Stableford was won by Josh Bullock who put together a good round to finish with 38pts.

Runner-up was Ashley Bullock who finished with 37pts.

Prize winners were Peter Payne, Trent Forrest 35pts; Paul West 35pts on a countback.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club nine-hole competition winner was Ashley Bullock who came away with the day’s victory with 31nett.

Runner-up on 33nett was Gary McCarroll.



Josh Bullock won Thursday’s Individual Stableford with 38 points.

Raffle winner was Paul McCarroll. Front nine holes to be played this week.

Leaders after Round 15 is Ashley Bullock on -9, with Adam, Joe and David Ryan, Tim Parker all on -7, and there are still plenty of rounds left to play.

Results for Round 7 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition:- Maulers defeated Bell River Bandits 5up, Power Rangers defeated The Masters 3up, Pheonix defeated Used Groceries 1up, Lion of Waterloo drew Soldiers Memorial Club, Dirty Birds defeated WMC 2up, Dirt Diggers drew Snipers, Kevaliers defeated Railway Boys 4up.

Points table after seven rounds has Kevalliers 32.9pts, Lion of Waterloo 28.4pts, Dirty Birds 26.3pts, Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws 26.1pts, Masters 24.3pts, Soldiers Memorial Club 21.9pts, Maulers 21.9pts, Power Rangers 20 2pts, Bell River Bandits 19.9pts, Pheonix 19.7pts, Used Groceries 19.6pts, Snipers 17.4pts, Railway Boys 14.1pts, Dirt Diggers 13.1pts.

All Golfers are reminded to get their memberships finalised by the end of January, for more information you can call into the Soldiers Memorial Club during office hours.

This Saturday’s events are an Individual Stableford plus Round 8 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition.

19th Hole



Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News

OUR LAST Swim for 2025 attracted 12 members on Tuesday, December 16.

Katharine O’Rourke took out the 30-metre event being 0.06 outside her time while Terry Dray won the 50-metre event being spot on his time.

Ivy & Darcy Lousick won the junior events.

Nick Knowles & Ari Lousick combined to win the Brace Relay being 1.91 outside their time.

Our first Swim for 2026 attracted 16 members on Tuesday,

January 6.

Katherine O’Rourke continued her good form winning the 30-metre event being spot on her time while Shane Lousick took out the 50-metre event being 0.07 outside his time.

Archie Rich won both junior events while Mason Hill and Darcy Lousick combined to win the Brace Relay being 0.37 outside their time.

The Western District Championships will be held in Cobar on Sunday 8 February 2026. Cost will be advised at our Tuesday Swim. New Members are always welcome for more information contact Terry Dray – 0408 294 526.

Results for Tuesday, January 6

Juniors

30 Metre: 1 Albert Rich 0.32+; 2 Ivy Lousick 0.87+; 3 Rhylee Hill 4.37-.

50 Metre: 1 Albert Rich 1.38+; 2 Archie Rich 3.57-; 3 Rhylee Hill 4.15+.

Seniors

30 Metre: 1 Katharine O’Rourke 0.00; 2 Lizzy George 0.54-; 3 Janelle Frappell 0.75-.

50 Metre: 1 Shane Lousick 0.07-; 2 Janelle Frappell 0.15-; 3 Nick Knowles 0.37-.

Brace Relay: 1 Mason Hill & Darcy Lousick 0.37-; 2 Rhylee Hill & Henry Willcockson 0.84-; 3 Nick Knowles & Albert Rich 8.12+.

The Platypus

Keeping weed numbers low pays off

By Cindy Benjamin, WeedSmart

ACCORDING TO CSIRO’s latest comprehensive national report, on-farm investment in integrated weed management practices is keeping residual weed numbers and weed-associated yield losses low on Australian grain and cotton farms.

Lead researcher and data analyst, CSIRO’s Jackie Ouzman, said growers’ investment in weed control was minimising yield losses from residual weeds growing in crops and fallows.

“From an economic perspective, the optimal level of weed control occurs when the marginal benefit of investing in an additional unit of weed control no longer outweighs the marginal cost,” she said.

“When both the current-season yield benefits and the long-term advantages of reducing the weed seed bank are taken into account, the investment in keeping weed density low usually pays off.”

This latest report on the impact of weeds in broadacre cropping systems, supported by the Grains Research and Development Corporation (GRDC) and the Cotton Research and Development Corporation (CRDC), confirms that yield losses due to weed pressure on Australian grain and cotton growers are relatively small.

This indicates that growers are ‘seedbank aware’ as they implement long-term, economically optimal strategies that maintain low in-crop weed densities.

“Growers are using a wide array of herbicide and non-herbicide tools to keep weed numbers low and maintain their flexibility in profitable farming systems,” Ms Ouzman said.

“The average annual expenditure on weed control is \$176/ha in grain and \$387/ha in

cotton production.”

“Weed pressure from weeds in grain crops reduces yields by an estimated three per cent, or \$24/ha. The revenue loss is split between residual weeds in crop, which cost growers \$12/ha, and weeds in fallow, which cost an additional \$12/ha.”

Weed control is one of the most expensive input costs in broadacre grain production systems, accounting for around 20 per cent of the average cash expenditure on grain farms.

In this new report, expenditure on weed control included the costs associated with using herbicides and seed technology and implementing a range of additional integrated weed management practices (IWM).

“Expenditure on in-season knockdown, pre- and post-emergent herbicides represents the largest weed control cost, accounting for 55pc of the total weed control spend for grain production, or \$97/ha,” Ms Ouzman said.

“In addition, grain growers invest an average of \$51/ha in other in-crop weed management practices and \$29/ha to control weeds on fallow fields, nationally.”

The total amount grain growers spent on weed control was similar for the northern, western and southern growing regions (\$174/ha to \$178/ha).

The costs associated with in-season and fallow herbicide programs are relatively straightforward to track on-farm, and the full cost can be attributed to weed control.

In contrast, other tactics used within an integrated weed management program are more complex to cost because they are often applied over small areas, and some have multiple benefits aside from weed control.

This analysis considered both the area of

land receiving each weed control practice and the cost of implementation, while also accounting for additional factors such as the level of attribution to weed control and the yield loss associated with some practices.

When considering the implementation of these strategies, keep in mind that the following practices are not applied to every hectare every year. The report provides estimated implementation costs and the percentage attributed to weed control for the following practices:

* Tillage prior to seeding costs \$40 in grains and \$50/ha in cotton, with 80pc of the cost attributed to weed control

* In grains, delayed seeding with knockdown costs \$30/ha to implement and incurs a yield reduction of 7 per cent. This tactic is 100pc attributable to weed control.

* Double knockdown for weed control costs \$25/ha to implement in grains and \$30/ha in cotton. This cost is 100pc attributable to weed control, and could be reduced if the second pass is done using weed detection spot-spraying technology.

* Harvest weed seed control in grain crops costs \$5–41/ha depending on the method used, and is 100pc attributable to weed control.

* Crop topping in suitable grain crops costs \$14/ha in cereals and \$16/ha in broadleaf crops to implement and incurs a yield reduction of 2–5pc. These costs are 100pc attributable to weed control.

* Stubble burning in grain systems costs \$1/ha, and is 90pc attributable to weed control.

* Green or brown manure crops cost an estimated \$213/ha to implement. This accounts for both revenue loss and improved yield in future crops. This practice has mul-

tiple benefits, including weed control.

* Break crops managed primarily for weed control costs \$80/ha, based on foregone revenue on more profitable crop choices, and is 100pc attributable to weed control.

* Competitive crop seeding in grain crops costs \$15/ha to implement and is 100pc attributable to weed control.

* Chipping costs \$5/ha in cotton crops, and is 100pc attributable to weed control.

The 2025 ‘Impact of weeds on Australian Grain and Cotton Production’ report does not include analysis of other weed control tactics used in broadacre cropping, such as grazing, hay making, soil amelioration, cover crops and inter-row cropping (in cotton crops), because these weed management practices are challenging to cost, due to their low adoption rates, highly variable costs, or the multiple agronomic benefits they provide.

The model also did not include fallow and in-crop weed detection and spot spraying technologies, due to the lack of available data for each analysis zone. When used in fallow (green-on-brown), this technology significantly reduces herbicide costs in regions where the practice is well-established. In-crop weed detection and spot-spraying (green-on-green) is not yet widely available but has the potential to reduce herbicide use and conserve yield by reducing the area of crop being treated with herbicide.

The analysis shows that Australian broad-acre growers are using the integrated weed man

For more information about economical and practical weed control tactics, visit the WeedSmart website:

www.weedsmart.org.au

Touch Footy Griffith Championships

Alysha Spradbrow photos



Country Regionals & Pointscore - Carmen Gain Photos

NSW Country Regionals – Goulburn

LAKYN AND Roman Dowton represented our club proudly at the NSW Country Regionals in Goulburn, producing outstanding performances across the meet.

Roman Dowton had an exceptional meet, highlighted by a first place finish in the 50m Freestyle, swimming a new personal best and breaking the WASC club record.

He also placed third in the 50m Butterfly, again a PB and another WASC club record and finished fifth in the 100m Freestyle.

Roman continued his strong form with a fourth place in the 100m Butterfly, achieving a PB and qualifying for Country Championships, along with seventh in the 50m Breaststroke

and fifth in the 100m Breaststroke.

Lakyn Dowton swam extremely well throughout the meet, placing fifth in both the 50m Freestyle and 100m Freestyle, and eight in the 50m Butterfly.

He backed this up on another strong day in the pool by smashing a PB to place second in the 50m Backstroke, finishing 12th in the 50m Breaststroke, and placing in the top five in the 200m Individual Medley.

A fantastic effort from both swimmers and a very successful meet for the club.

Well done boys!

Carmen Gain



Lakyn and Roman Dowton.



Wellington Touch teams shine at Suns Championships in Griffith

TAKING ON strong competition from across the region and showcasing skill, teamwork and plenty of Wellington spirit, the Wellington representative touch football teams travelled to Griffith over the weekend to compete in the Suns Touch Championships.

The Under 10 Girls had an outstanding tournament, winning every game throughout the rounds and earning a well-deserved place in the finals.

After an incredible run, the girls came up against a strong Parkes side in the grand final and, despite their best efforts, finished as runners-up.

Their determination, teamwork and consistency across the weekend was something to be proud of.

The Under 12 Boys also had a fantastic campaign, just missing out on a finals spot by only two tries.

The team showed impressive development throughout the tournament, with players building confidence, improving their skills, and forming strong friendships on and off the field.

Their growth as a team was clear for everyone to see.

Wellington's Under 14 Girls worked hard all weekend, playing with great structure and supporting one another in every match.

They scored some excellent tries against tough opposition and continued to build strong combinations as the tournament progressed

. Their teamwork and resilience stood out against some very competitive teams.

Overall, it was a successful and memorable trip for Wellington Touch, with all teams demonstrating great sportsmanship, improvement and pride in representing their town.

Looking ahead, Wellington Touch has an exciting few



Wellington Touch Under 10 Girls made it to the grand final to be narrowly defeated by Parkes

Under 12 Boys and Under 14 Girls also played extraordinarily well for Wellington throughout the competition.

weeks coming up, with representative teams heading to Nelson Bay at the end of January for another strong round of competition and development.

The season will then continue into February with the Junior State Cup, where players will have the opportunity to test themselves against the best junior touch teams in the state and continue building skills, teamwork and confidence on a bigger stage.

Alysha Spradbrow



In Their Sights



Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Result of Saturday, January 17
Hunting Class: S. King 99.9; L. Hough 98; R. Dowton 90.5; D. Gollan 89; R. Galea 89.
600 yards: L. Hough 105.3; S. King 102.2; B. Hollow 102.1; J. Haberecht 100.2.
Next shoot Saturday, January 31 including General Meeting.
The Rifleman.

CASH
Fever

\$6,200

FRIDAY 23 JANUARY

FRIDAY &
SUNDAY NIGHTS

DRAWN BETWEEN 6.30PM TO 8.30PM

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ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

6845 2877

If you are aged 18 to 30 years on April 10, 2026
You are invited to enter the

2026
TOOHEYS
GUYS & DOLLS
Challenge

There are 14 places to match 14 horses eligible to run in the
2026 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
Wellington Boot race
to be run on Sunday, April 12.

All entries will be placed into a barrel and 14 names will be drawn during
the Wellington Boot Calcutta at Wellington Soldiers Club
from 7pm Saturday, April 11

Each person drawn from the barrel will then draw a horse
entered for the Boot race. Bonus prizes for the
first three placegetters.

Conditions of entry:
Nominees must be at the Calcutta night and must be at the Boot Races
on Sunday as guests of Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Club,
Wellington & District Leader and Wellington Race Club

Nomination Forms
at the Soldiers Club from 2nd February, 2026.
Further conditions of entry of nomination form

MEMBERS BADGE DRAW

TUESDAY'S
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S

The prize bank is growing! Don't miss out!
You must be at the Club to Win!

CASH FEVER
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S

DRAWN BETWEEN 6.30PM TO 8.30PM

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MUSIC

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SATURDAY 31ST JANUARY
STARTS FROM 7.30PM

PUB ROCK TO GET YOU SINGING ALONG AND DANCING!